

» CRABS AND RELATIVES



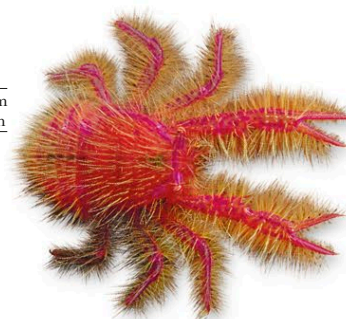
30–40 cm
12–16 in

ROBBER CRAB

Birgus latro
F: Coenobitidae

The largest land-living arthropod, this hermit crab is a relative of squat lobsters and inhabits Indo-Pacific island forests, eating coconuts using its massive pincers.

1 cm
3/8 in



PINK SQUAT LOBSTER

Lauriea siagiani
F: Galatheidae

Many tropical squat lobsters are associated with specific reef organisms. This tiny, hairy Indonesian species lives on *Xestospongia* vase sponges.

BLUE-STRIPED SQUAT LOBSTER

Galathea strigosa
F: Galatheidae

Slender-clawed squat lobsters such as this European species are decapods (ten-legged), but the last leg pair is reduced, making them appear eight-legged.



7–9 cm
2 3/4–3 1/2 in



2 cm
1 1/4 in

anemone
attached
to shell

ANEMONE PORCELAIN CRAB

Neopetrolisthes maculatus
F: Porcellanidae

Porcelain crabs are tiny, eight-legged decapods more closely related to squat lobsters than true crabs. This Indo-Pacific species lives in giant *Stichodactyla* anemones.

8–12 mm
5/16–1/2 in



INDO-PACIFIC PEA CRAB

Pinnotheres sp.
F: Pinnotheridae

Tiny pea crabs complete their life cycle on or in the body of other marine invertebrates. This Philippine species lives on cup corals.



antenna

WHITE-SPOTTED HERMIT CRAB

Dardanus megistos
F: Diogenidae

This crustacean of the E. Atlantic and Indo-Pacific coasts is a "left-handed" hermit crab, with an enlarged left claw.

ANEMONE HERMIT CRAB

Dardanus pedunculatus
F: Diogenidae

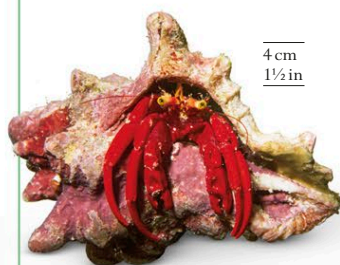
This hermit crab of Indo-Pacific reefs always carries a *Calliactis* anemone on its shell, which shares its food and provides camouflaged protection.

6–10 cm
2 1/4–4 in

RED REEF HERMIT CRAB

Paguristes cadenati
F: Diogenidae

Hermit crabs inhabit discarded snail shells that accommodate their soft coiled abdomen. This species lives on Indo-Pacific and E. Atlantic reefs.



4 cm
1 1/2 in



13–20 cm
5–8 in